

Wildcats Explode In Fifth To Coast Past Miners, 11-2

By DAVE ADAM
Star Staff Writer

The University of Arizona baseball team, handcuffed through four innings by Texas-El Paso pitcher Roy Stringer, exploded for 10 runs in the fifth inning and coasted to an 11-2 victory Friday in a Western Athletic Conference Southern Division game.

Wildcat right-hander Dave Breuker scattered five hits and struck out 15 batters in posting his 11th win of the season against no defeats.

The victory boosted Arizona to 44-2 for the season and 4-0 in the Southern Division. The Miners fell to 21-14 for the year and 1-3 in the division.

The two teams wind up their three-game series today with a 1 p.m. doubleheader at Wildcat Field. KZAZ-TV will televise the nine-inning first game and KTUC-Radio (1400) will broadcast the play-by-play.

A crowd of 2,208 — the largest of the season at Wildcat Field — sat silently while Breuker and Stringer dueled in the early innings.

UTEP broke through in the third inning when second baseman Mike Miller lifted a fly ball high into the air in right field. A moderate wind blowing out caught the ball and carried it just over the fence at the 360-foot mark for a two-run homer.

Stringer, who beat Arizona State 7-5 last Friday, allowed the leadoff batter to reach first base in each of the first three innings but got out of trouble on each occasion.

In the first inning Dave Stegman reached first on an error and advanced to second on a wild pitch. But Stringer rallied to strike out the next three batters.

In the second, Arizona catcher Dennis Haines drew a walk but was thrown out trying to steal second as Jim Filippelli struck out at the plate.

And in the third, designated hitter Marty Reid doubled to left field and reached third when Stegman dumped a one-out bunt single down the third base line. But Stringer then induced Ben Heise to ground into a double play.

Through four innings Stringer held the 'Cats to two hits while striking out five.

But in the fifth inning, after running the count to 0-2 on Scott Norris, Stringer faded and walked three straight batters. Then Stegman slashed a solid single to left to score one run, Heise chopped one up the middle to drive in two more and Stringer was lifted for a reliever.

UTEP coach Andy Cohen said that as soon as Stringer walked Norris, it was evident the Miner pitcher was struggling.

"He just gave out in the fifth inning," Cohen said. "He was forcing himself. When he was ahead 0-2 and then walked the guy I knew it was the end."

Ron Hassy greeted right-hander Tony Medellin by hitting a double to the wall in left field to score Stegman and Heise. Haines walked for the third straight time and Norris then cleared the bases with a booming home run over the center field fence that bounded off a truck parked along North Martin Avenue.

Heise padded Arizona's lead by hitting a second two-run single of the inning before Thompson popped out to end the rally.

Breuker went the distance for the Wildcats and allowed but one baserunner to reach third base after the third inning. He struck out three batters in the fourth inning and two batters in the first, third, fifth and sixth innings. His 15 strikeouts brought him within two of tying the WAC record of 17 strikeouts in a conference game. His performance was also the highest strikeout total this season by an Arizona pitcher.

"I had pretty good control," Breuker said. "I was throwing my slider where I wanted it and they wre swinging at the pitches that were balls.

"That Stringer is a good little pitcher. I can see how he beat Arizona State."

Cohen will start right-handers Jeff Hogan and Dan Modlinski on the mound today while Kindall will go with Mark Schimpf and Joel Godfrey.



UTEP					Arizona				
	ab	r	h	bi		ab	r	h	bi
Von Hagen lf	3	0	0	0	Stegman cf	4	1	2	1
Miller 2b	4	1	2	0	Heise ss	5	1	2	4
Villarreal 3b	4	0	1	0	Thompson 1b	2	1	1	0
Stringer p	2	0	0	0	Hasssey 3b	5	1	1	2
Knox p	1	0	0	0	Haines c	1	1	0	0
Downing ph	1	0	0	0	Filippelli lf	5	0	1	1
Pennies cf	3	0	1	0	Norris rf	4	2	2	3
Dillingham rf	4	0	0	0	Reid dh	1	0	0	0
Rushing lb	4	0	1	0	Starke pr-dh	2	0	0	0
Brundage c	4	0	0	0	O'Sullivan 2b	1	0	0	0
Nance ss	2	1	1	0	Bolek ph	0	2	0	0
					Russell 2b	1	0	0	0
Totals	32	2	5	2	Totals	34	11	10	11
UTEP					002	000	000	—	2
Arizona					000	0(10)	01x	—	11